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NRES 315: Course Launch

Fall 2026
Week 01

Human Dimensions of Fish and Wildlife Management

Last updated: 2026-08-24

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Welcome to NRES 315

This course examines the human actions, social processes, and social-ecological relationships that shape fish and wildlife management. Today is a brief launch. Wednesday is our full Chapter 1 session.

Course framing: Chapter 1, §1.3, Schedule course syllabus.

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The recurring course question

Fish and wildlife management decisions involve people, habitats, and species.

Across the semester, we will ask:

What decision is being made, what evidence matters, who is affected, and which tradeoffs must be addressed?

Chapter 1 framing: §§1.2.1-1.3.

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How our weeks work

Monday	Wednesday	Friday
Frame the chapter and management question	Lecture, concept check, and case preparation	Rotating small-group application
Complete reading preparation	Bring one claim and one question	Submit one shared response and a private Friday Group Check

Source: course syllabus, "Weekly rhythm"

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How the course is assessed

- **Reading quizzes** — 25%: short, individual preparation checks; the lowest one score is dropped.
- **Weekly group applications** — 75%: fifteen in-class applications; the lowest one score is dropped.
- Each application score is **80% shared reasoning** and **20% individual contribution accountability**.

Source: course syllabus, "Assessment and grading"

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Your Week 1 checklist

1. Find the Week 1 module in Canvas.
2. Read Chapter 1.
3. Complete the individual quiz by Sunday, August 30, at 11:59 p.m., before Week 02 Monday class.
4. Come Wednesday ready to discuss one management question from the chapter.
5. Come Friday ready for the first graded Chesapeake Bay application.

Source: Week 1 Canvas module and Chapter 1

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A question to carry into Wednesday

Chapter 1 argues that biology and ecology are essential—but cannot independently determine:

- which goals should be pursued;
- which tradeoffs are acceptable; or
- who should participate.

Write down one fish or wildlife decision for which you think one of those questions would matter.

Source: Chapter 1, §§1.2–1.2.1

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Wednesday begins Chapter 1 in full

Bring your Chapter 1 question back on Wednesday.

We will work through values and actions, people-habitats-species, research and participation, and the everyday work of human dimensions.

Source: Chapter 1, §§1.2–1.5

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